

# Workspace Transfer Guide

HCL Sathee — Vercel & Render ownership handover, and multi-project setup

---

Covers: how to permanently hand over the deployed project to someone else's account on Vercel and Render, why Render works differently from Vercel here, and how one Render account can cleanly host multiple separate, unrelated projects for different people.

## 1. Vercel — Project Transfer (fully supported)

---

Vercel has a genuine, self-service **Transfer** feature for moving a project to another account/team, confirmed directly in your dashboard under Project Settings.

- 1 The destination account creates their own Vercel account and a Team (if they don't have one).
- 2 In your project's **Settings**, find the **Transfer** section and click **Transfer**.
- 3 Specify the destination Team name/slug, or copy the generated transfer link.
- 4 Send the link (or have them search for the request) — **they must accept it from their own account**. You cannot complete a transfer alone.
- 5 If their Team isn't already upgraded to a supporting plan, Vercel may prompt them to upgrade during acceptance.
- 6 Once accepted, the project (deploy history, domains, env vars) moves intact — this is not the same as creating a new empty project.

### To fully exit afterward (permanent handover)

After confirming everything works under their ownership, go to that Team's Settings and click **Leave Team**. Per Vercel's own text on that screen: *"Revoke your access to this Team. Any resources you've added to the Team will remain."* The project stays fully intact under their account — you simply lose access. Your own Gmail/Vercel account is never touched, shared, or handed over in this process.

## 2. Render — No self-service transfer (verified against Render's own docs)

---

**NOTE:** Render's official documentation ("Workspaces, Members, and Roles") does not mention any Transfer Service or Transfer Workspace feature. There is no direct equivalent to Vercel's Transfer button on Render today.

### Option A — Recreate the service in the destination workspace (realistic path)

- 1 The destination person creates their own Render account and a Pro (or higher) workspace.
- 2 They click **New** → **Web Service** in their workspace.
- 3 Connect the same GitHub repository (they need at least collaborator access to it, or a fork).
- 4 Select the same branch.
- 5 Copy over the configuration from the current service: runtime, build command, start command, root directory, environment variables, instance type/plan, region, and health check path.
- 6 Create and deploy the new Web Service; verify it works end-to-end.

- 7 Only after confirming the new service is fully working, delete the old one from your workspace.

| Env var to copy                                                             | Where it currently lives                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| JWT_SECRET                                                                  | Server/.env                                          |
| CLIENT_URL                                                                  | Server/.env                                          |
| FIREBASE_STORAGE_BUCKET,<br>firebase-service-account.json                   | Server/.env + service account file                   |
| SUPABASE_URL,<br>SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY                                  | Server/.env                                          |
| EMAIL_USER, EMAIL_CLIENT_ID,<br>EMAIL_CLIENT_SECRET,<br>EMAIL_REFRESH_TOKEN | Server/.env                                          |
| PORT                                                                        | Server/.env (Render usually sets this automatically) |

### Option B — Full workspace-to-organization transfer (only if applicable)

If the destination is a Render **Organization** (Scale/Enterprise tier managing multiple workspaces), Render Support can manually transfer an entire workspace into that organization on request. This is not self-service — it requires opening a support ticket with: current workspace name, workspace ID if available, destination organization name, your Render account email, and confirmation you're authorized to make the transfer. Render states that every member of the transferred workspace becomes a member of the destination organization.

**NOTE:** Option B moves the whole workspace, not a single service, and only applies when the destination is an actual Render Organization (Scale/Enterprise) rather than a normal Pro workspace. For a single Web Service moving to someone's regular Pro workspace, Option A is the correct path.

## 3. Multiple Separate Projects Under One Render Account

Confirmed directly from Render's documentation: "You can create additional workspaces... You can create an unlimited number of paid workspaces" and "Everything you create on Render... belongs to a workspace." This means one Render account can cleanly host multiple, fully isolated projects for different people.

| Account      | Workspace              | Contains                                     | Members                         |
|--------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ab@gmail.com | "hcl-sathee" (Pro)     | HCL Sathee Web Service                       | Person 2 (owner) + you          |
| ab@gmail.com | Second workspace (Pro) | Person 3's own Web Service + Private Service | Person 3 (owner) + ab@gmail.com |

- Each workspace is a fully separate container — separate resource list, separate member list.
- Person 2/you have zero visibility into the second workspace; Person 3 has zero visibility into "hcl-sathee." This isolation is the normal, supported behavior, not a special setup.
- **Billing is per workspace** on the standard Pro plan: two Pro workspaces under one account means two separate \$25/month-plus-compute charges. Render's Scale plan (\$499/mo) is the tier built for managing several workspaces under one billed organization, if that becomes worth it at higher project counts.

## 4. Quick Reference: Adding a Collaborator

| Platform | Requires paid plan to invite?                                         | Where                                                |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Vercel   | Yes — Team (Pro) required; personal accounts can't invite anyone      | Team Settings → Members → Invite Member              |
| Render   | Yes — workspace must be Pro or higher; Hobby workspaces cap at 1 seat | Workspace Settings → Team members → + Invite members |
| Supabase | No — free on any plan, managed at the Organization level              | Organization Settings → Team → Invite a member       |